

Jun 7, 2026

MeaningBridge

Invited Remington Crawford Robert Neimeyer Danielle Franklin Robert A Neimeyer

Attachments 📎 MeaningBridge

Meeting records 📄 Transcript

Summary

Meeting Bridge review confirmed technical Retrieval Augmented Generation implementation and prioritized for-profit entity formation for funding.

Artificial Intelligence Strategy Review

The team prioritized training the model on expert knowledge while utilizing Retrieval Augmented Generation to ensure accuracy. This strategy secures intellectual property and minimizes potential hallucinations.

User Experience And Features

Evaluation of the platform demonstrated effective therapeutic interactions and journaling capabilities. Development will focus on enhancing user tools like voice to text integration and personal imagery uploads.

Investment And Launch Strategy

A major decision was made to pursue a for-profit business entity to facilitate venture capital investment rather than relying on grants. The current release strategy focuses on private professional feedback.

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Decisions

ALIGNED

- **Living Beyond Loss book integration** The team established the strategy to use Dr. Neimeyer's book 'Living Beyond Loss' as the foundational data source for training the AI model.
- **Implementation of voice-to-text feature** The team committed to implementing a voice-to-text feature, such as Whisper, to enable users to interact with the platform through speech.
- **Support for user photo uploads** The group decided to integrate a feature allowing users to upload images of the deceased or meaningful items to support the user experience.
- **Breathing exercise counter feature** The breathing exercise interface will include a toggle-able counter feature to assist users while minimizing potential distractions.
- **Caregiver portal refinement** The caregiver portal design will be updated to replace the potentially ambiguous 'walking along' metaphor and clarify terminology to distinguish between professional therapists and family support roles.
- **Network feedback solicitation** The platform will be shared with the professional network for feedback in its current state, including dummy data, prior to full development.
- **Social media launch postponement** Public social media promotion will be deferred until the payment and user sign-up systems are fully implemented.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

Next steps

- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Collect Training Materials: Gather copies of books and data from Robert Neimeyer to prepare for model training.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Consult IP Attorney: Inquire with Mike Clyce about potential copyright or licensing issues regarding the integration of published book content into the artificial intelligence system.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Resend App Link: Distribute the link for the MeaningBridge application to the meeting participants.
- ☐ [The group] Train AI Model: Use collected intellectual property and transcripts to develop the system.
- ☐ [The group] Test AI System: Evaluate the model performance following the training phase.
- ☐ [Remington Crawford] Send Flea Spray Link: Provide the Amazon link for the natural cottonseed and clove oil flea spray used for the dog.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Update Access: Modify the platform to ensure proper session management for all users instead of defaulting to the creator account.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Add Numeric Labels: Include numerical values on sliders to assist users in identifying their rating scale.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Implement Voice to Text: Add an audio input option for the platform to allow users to speak responses instead of typing.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Enable Image Uploads: Add functionality for users to upload and attach photos of a deceased loved one or meaningful object.
- ☐ [Robert Neimeyer] Review App Tabs: Examine the journal, practices, and caregiver modules to provide improvement suggestions.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Create Home Tab: Add a direct navigation link back to the main landing page to improve user experience.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Adjust Metaphor: Change the walking metaphor to ensure it is interpreted appropriately by all user demographics.
- ☐ [Danielle Franklin] Update Terminology: Adjust labels from caregiver to clarify the inclusion of professional therapists and counselors.
- ☐ [Robert Neimeyer] Provide Training Material: Deliver relevant documents to assist in training the language model.

- [Robert Neimeyer, Remington Crawford] Brainstorm Next Steps: Meet to discuss business strategies and operational updates before reporting back to Danielle.

Details

- **Meeting Commencement and Technical Setup:** The meeting began with troubleshooting regarding audio and connection issues, which Danielle Franklin identified as a result of a calendar link error ([00:00:57](#)) ([00:09:17](#)). Following the resolution of these issues, the participants shared personal updates, with Remington Crawford noting recent family matters and Robert Neimeyer joining the call after returning from travel ([00:08:36](#)) ([00:10:58](#)).
- **Robert Neimeyer's Travel and Professional Engagement:** Robert Neimeyer provided an update on a recent trip to Chicago and Wisconsin, detailing attendance at a conference with psychoanalysts and delivering a keynote speech in Lacrosse, Wisconsin. Robert Neimeyer characterized the psychoanalysts as a traditional group that relied on reading papers without slides, whereas the Wisconsin conference was described as a smaller, friendly gathering of under 100 people ([00:10:58](#)).
- **Meeting Bridge Conference Follow-up:** Danielle Franklin reported that there were new signups for the "Meeting Bridge" system following the recent conference. Robert Neimeyer noted that a slide regarding the project was inadvertently skipped during the presentation but indicated they would attempt to rectify this by contacting the organizer to have information included in final evaluations ([00:12:50](#)).
- **Strategic Vision for Meaning Bridge:** Danielle Franklin emphasized the importance of gathering user feedback to shape the product and suggested that the team should build features based on initial usage ([00:13:49](#)). The group discussed the long-term vision of the system as a support mechanism that bridges individuals through the grieving process, potentially functioning as a continuum of care that adheres to HIPAA restrictions ([00:14:46](#)).
- **Community and Forum Features:** Remington Crawford proposed the future implementation of a forum or community gathering space within the application to increase user retention and decrease the isolation experienced by those grieving ([00:14:46](#)). Robert Neimeyer expressed interest in the concept,

comparing it to the Jasper community, and noted that such an architecture could effectively mitigate isolation and link the client's work with the AI agent to a broader support network ([00:15:53](#)).

- **AI Training and Model Development:** Danielle Franklin stressed the necessity of training the AI model using Robert Neimeyer's books and data, focusing on creating a "clean" model without client data ([00:16:49](#)). The team agreed to focus on building the intellectual property of the model itself by incorporating Robert Neimeyer's expert knowledge, which would persist regardless of future implementation choices ([00:18:06](#)) ([00:20:20](#)).
- **Business and Investment Considerations:** Danielle Franklin discussed the transition from grant-based work to seeking investment, noting that establishing a for-profit business entity, such as in Delaware, would be necessary for funding ([00:19:02](#)) ([00:29:04](#)). Robert Neimeyer and the team discussed the possibility of housing the project under existing structures, such as the Portland Institute, while ensuring the underlying technology remains protected as intellectual property ([00:30:01](#)).
- **Intellectual Property and Publishing:** The participants explored potential intellectual property conflicts regarding the use of Robert Neimeyer's published books for AI training ([00:19:02](#)) ([00:33:01](#)). Robert Neimeyer clarified that intellectual property generally covers ideas rather than the specific language, and noted a long-standing relationship with the publisher Routledge since 1983, which they expected would allow for collaboration without significant difficulty ([00:33:56](#)).
- **Marketing and User Acquisition:** Danielle Franklin shared insights from a recent viral social media post, noting the importance of storytelling and emotional connection in advertising ([00:22:47](#)). The team discussed using Google Ads, through a grant held by Danielle Franklin's nonprofit, to facilitate future mass marketing efforts once the platform is ready for launch ([00:21:34](#)).
- **Technical Nature of the AI Agent:** Danielle Franklin explained that the AI model would utilize a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) approach to ensure accuracy and minimize hallucinations by drawing from specific datasets ([00:26:56](#)). Remington Crawford added that they have developed a new compaction system that enhances the AI's ability to maintain consciousness, awareness, and thread persistence over time, allowing for more complex, conversational interactions ([00:28:04](#)).

- **Website Functionality Review:** The group proceeded to review the Meeting Bridge website interface, with Danielle Franklin guiding the others through the various tabs ([00:43:03](#)). Robert Neimeyer expressed positive feedback on the visual design, specifically the plant imagery used to represent transformation ([00:44:15](#)).
- **User Interaction and Insights:** Danielle Franklin demonstrated the "check-in" feature, which allows users to log their state and view trends over time in an "Insights" tab. Remington Crawford suggested adding numerical values to sliders for better data tracking, which Danielle Franklin confirmed was already part of the system's capabilities ([00:45:59](#)).
- **Application Sessions and Demo:** The participants tested the "Companion" tab, which includes sessions for "Continuing Bonds" and "Meaning Reconstruction" ([00:47:51](#)). Robert Neimeyer successfully interacted with the AI, receiving responses that were described as validating and conversational, which the group agreed would be effective in a therapeutic context ([00:55:17](#)).
- **Future Feature Enhancements:** The group discussed several potential upgrades, including the integration of voice-to-text functionality to allow users to speak rather than type, and the ability for users to upload personal photos related to their loss ([00:53:49](#)). Remington Crawford suggested that the AI could automatically select icons or imagery based on user discussions to make the experience more personalized ([00:54:32](#)).
- **Journaling and Data Analysis:** Toward the end of the session, the team reviewed the "Journal" tab, which offers prompts for users to process their experiences. Remington Crawford noted that the system could potentially extrapolate data from these entries to identify trends and keywords, which could be used to further refine the user experience ([00:57:26](#)).
- **Practices Module and Feature Requests:** Danielle Franklin leads a review of the "practices" tab, which includes exercises like box breathing and writing letters that will not be sent ([00:58:21](#)). Remington Crawford proposes adding a counter to these practices with a toggle feature, allowing users to turn it off to minimize distraction. They discuss utilizing these modules for multi-day training sessions where participants can trial them ([00:59:46](#)).
- **Website Navigation Challenges:** During the review, the group experiences issues with the site's navigation, specifically when attempting to return to the main home screen. Danielle Franklin acknowledges the technical difficulty and notes that the navigation links require repair ([01:01:34](#)).

- **Plans and Pricing Overview:** Danielle Franklin encourages Robert Neimeyer to review the "plans" section, which outlines user plans. They confirm that the costs currently listed are placeholder numbers, and the team agrees to address the actual pricing structure in the future ([01:02:12](#)).
- **Feedback and Transcription Process:** Danielle Franklin suggests that Robert Neimeyer can submit feedback via audio recordings if writing becomes too time-consuming. They clarify that various devices can be used for recording, and that software such as Gemini or built-in ASR tools can be utilized for transcription ([01:03:01](#)).
- **Caregiver Portal Terminology and Metaphors:** Robert Neimeyer reviews the caregiver portal, which tracks engagement scores and safety. They express concern that the "walking along with" metaphor might be interpreted too concretely, particularly by users for whom English is a second language, leading to a discussion on whether to adjust the language ([01:03:45](#)). Additionally, they discuss the term "caregiver" and suggest that it might need to be refined to "professional supporters" or "therapists" to distinguish between clinical professionals and family members ([01:05:36](#)).
- **Client Data and Consultation Features:** The group reviews the dummy data populated in the client list, which displays support levels, companion conversation times, and sleep quality. They discuss the functionality that allows users to send notes and schedule consultations, which the team plans to demonstrate to professional networks to gather further feedback ([01:06:47](#)).
- **Launch Strategy and Public Sharing:** Regarding the release of the platform, the team determines it is premature to post on social media because the payment system is not yet operational. Instead, they agree to continue gathering feedback by sharing the link privately with professional contacts via word of mouth ([01:08:40](#)).
- **Scheduling and Future Meetings:** Robert Neimeyer outlines a travel schedule that includes trips to Mexico and Singapore, noting that the latter will create time zone challenges ([01:09:27](#)). The participants agree to manage collaboration primarily through email, with periodic synchronization meetings arranged when necessary ([01:10:36](#)).
- **Business and Funding Strategy:** Robert Neimeyer identifies three potential paths for the platform: direct development and app marketing, applying for grants, or seeking investment ([01:12:28](#)). Danielle Franklin argues that the venture capital investment route is more reliable than grants, suggesting that a subscription

model combined with Robert Neimeyer's reputation could attract significant investment ([01:13:26](#)).

- **Material Submission and Integration:** Robert Neimeyer asks about the best format for submitting materials to be ingested by the AI. Danielle Franklin confirms that they can accept various file formats, including Word documents, PDFs, or links to content, which they will then use to feed into the system ([01:14:19](#)).

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